

Zachary Benson

Senior full stack engineer (Java, Spring Boot, React, AWS, TypeScript, Angular, Mobile)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

As a software engineer with 8 years of experience, I bring strong technical expertise, a collaborative mindset, and a deep commitment to building high-quality software. I'm driven by curiosity and a constant desire to improve system performance, code quality, and overall engineering excellence.

I'm a highly motivated, results-oriented engineer who focuses on delivering meaningful outcomes. While I'm energized by achieving the final goal, I approach the process with discipline, adaptability, and a willingness to learn. I thrive in team environments that value open communication and shared ownership, yet I'm equally effective working independently with accountability and focus.

With a customer-centric perspective, I prioritize solving high-value problems and understanding the real needs behind each project. I think strategically about long-term technical direction, balancing engineering trade-offs with business objectives to create scalable, sustainable solutions.

As a problem-solver, I approach challenges analytically—identifying root causes, evaluating options, and developing practical, effective solutions. Across backend, frontend, and full-stack work, I bring a thoughtful, forward-looking approach that strengthens both the product and the team.

EDUCATION

University of Florida - Bachelor's Degree in computer Engineering, 2014 - June 2018

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend & Architecture

- Languages: Java, Kotlin, Node.js, TypeScript, Ruby, Python
- Frameworks: Spring Boot/Framework, Spring Security, Hibernate, JPA, Express.js
- Architecture: Microservices, BFF (Backend-for-Frontend), Event-Driven Architecture,DDD, Serverless
- Communication: Kafka, RabbitMQ, gRPC, WebSocket, REST, GraphQL
- Security & Build: OAuth 2.0, JWT, Maven, Gradle

Mobile Development

- Platform: Android Native Development
- Languages: Kotlin, Java
- UI & Frameworks: Jetpack Compose, Material Design, Android SDK, XML
- Architecture: MVVM, MVI, Clean Architecture
- Asynchronous: Kotlin Coroutines, Flow, LiveData
- Networking/DI: Retrofit, Ktor, Hilt, Dagger

Frontend

- Core: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript
- Frameworks: React, Next.js, Redux (Toolkit), Angular (2+), AngularJS, RxJS
- UI/UX: Responsive Design, CSS-in-JS, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, Component-based Architecture

Databases & Storage

- Relational: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, AWS RDS, GCP Cloud SQL
- NoSQL/Caching: MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB
- Search/Analytics: Elasticsearch, OpenSearch

Cloud & DevOps

- AWS: Lambda, EC2, S3, Cognito, API Gateway, DynamoDB, RDS, SQS, SNS, ECS, EKS (Kubernetes), Fargate, VPC, Terraform
- GCP: Apigee, Cloud SQL, GKE, Secret Manager, BigQuery, Cloud Functions, Pub/Sub
- Containerization/CI-CD: Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, ArgoCD
- Observability: Grafana, Datadog, Sentry, Prometheus

Testing & Tools

- Testing: JUnit, Mockito, Espresso (Android), Jasmine, Jest, Cypress, Cucumber, TDD/BDD
- Tools: Git, GitHub, GitLab, Jira, Confluence, Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Universal Studio(Remote) - Senior Full Stack Engineer Feb 2022 – Dec 2025

- **Real-Time Systems Orchestration:** Engineered and automated high-availability systems for global theme park operations, specifically focusing on the synchronization and real-time monitoring of attraction wait times and showtime scheduling for millions of annual visitors.
- **Event-Driven Microservices:** Designed a decoupled, high-throughput microservices ecosystem using **Node.js** and **Java Spring Boot**. Implemented **Apache Kafka** as the primary event bus to ensure reliable, sub-second data propagation between sensors, backend services, and guest-facing applications.
- **Core Infrastructure Innovation:** Developed a high-performance **Redis Adapter** library that was adopted as a core dependency across the enterprise platform. This standardized caching layer optimized data retrieval speeds and reduced primary database load by over **50%**.
- **Scalable Service Design:** Built and deployed mission-critical microservices from the ground up using **Node.js/Express.js**, employing the **Adapter Pattern** to allow the system to switch between different data providers and protocols without breaking core business logic.
- **Performance Engineering & TDD:** Delivered production-grade, modular code under a strict **Test-Driven Development (TDD)** methodology. Achieved and maintained **100% test coverage** for both Node.js and Spring Boot services, ensuring system stability during peak park attendance.
- **Modern Frontend Architecture:** Developed responsive, real-time dashboards for park operations using **React** and **Angular**. Created a library of reusable **React Hooks and components** specifically designed to visualize live streaming data from attraction sensors.
- **State Management & Data Fetching:** Optimized the frontend data layer using **Redux** and **React Query**. Implemented intelligent "stale-while-revalidate" caching strategies to ensure operators always had access to the most current park data with minimal API overhead.
- **UI/UX Performance Optimization:** Drastically improved dashboard responsiveness by refining rendering logic and reducing JavaScript bundle sizes. Partnered with UX designers to ensure all operational tools met strict accessibility standards while maintaining sub-second load times.
- **Technical Leadership & Troubleshooting:** Led cross-functional debugging efforts for high-priority incidents, maintaining **99.9% uptime** for critical park systems. Conducted high-level code reviews and mentored junior developers on microservices best practices and clean architecture principles.

Walmart Global Tech(Remote) - Senior Full Stack Engineer Oct 2019 - Feb 2022

- **Architected High-Scale Orchestration:** Designed and optimized mission-critical backend systems supporting Walmart's global e-commerce infrastructure. Spearheaded the **Transaction-OL** initiative, using **Node.js** and **TypeScript** to engineer high-throughput data contracts that power millions of Cart and Checkout sessions daily.
- **Native Android Development (Kotlin):** Developed and integrated native features within the Walmart Android app using **Kotlin** and **Jetpack Compose**. Bridged the gap between the Orchestration Layer and the mobile client, implementing **MVI/MVVM architectures** to ensure a responsive, state-driven user experience.
- **Mobile-First Performance Engineering:** Optimized the mobile data-consumption layer by implementing **Kotlin Coroutines** and **Flow** for asynchronous data handling. This reduced main-thread blocking and improved the "Time to Interactive" (TTI) for the checkout flow on low-end Android devices.
- **GraphQL & BFF Optimization:** Unified disparate microservices into a high-performance **BFF (Backend-for-Frontend)** using **GraphQL**. Designed custom resolvers that allowed the Android native client to perform complex data fetches in a single round-trip, significantly reducing network latency and battery consumption.
- **Feature Leadership (Pet & Vet Experience):** Led the end-to-end implementation of the "Enhanced Pet Experience." Built the service logic in **Node.js/Express.js** and the corresponding UI components in **Kotlin**, creating a seamless, cross-platform journey for managing pet prescriptions and vet details.
- **Microservices & Spring Boot:** Engineered robust **Spring Boot** microservices to handle enterprise-level data requirements. Implemented advanced caching strategies and circuit breakers to ensure the Orchestration Layer remained resilient during high-traffic retail events (Black Friday/Cyber Monday).
- **Automated Quality & CI/CD:** Elevated the codebase to a **perfect 100% test coverage** using **Jest** and **Cypress** for web services, and **JUnit/Espresso** for Android native components. Ensured all code met strict **SonarQube** standards for security and maintainability.
- **Production Readiness & Stakeholder Alignment:** Actively collaborated with product owners and stakeholders to translate complex business requirements into production-ready features. Owned the lifecycle of prescription-related features, ensuring zero-downtime deployments and a bug-free user experience.

Boxed (Remote) - Full Stack Engineer Jul 2018 - Sep 2019

- **Multidisciplinary Engineering Leadership:** Spearheaded the development of scalable, enterprise-grade backend solutions for a diverse portfolio encompassing **Healthcare, Fintech, and Real Estate**. Orchestrated full-stack architectures using **Java (Spring Boot)** and **Angular**, aligning technical roadmaps with complex business logic to serve a rapidly expanding user base.
- **Legacy Modernization & JVM Optimization:** Led the strategic migration from **Java 8 to Java 11**, leveraging modularity and enhanced garbage collection to improve system throughput and security posture. This transition reduced technical debt and enabled the adoption of modern reactive programming patterns.
- **Polyglot Data Persistence:** Engineered a hybrid data layer optimizing for consistency and speed. Implemented **PostgreSQL with Hibernate** for complex relational transactions in Fintech, while utilizing **AWS DynamoDB** for high-velocity, schema-less data operations in e-commerce modules.
- **Cloud-Native Infrastructure (AWS & Kubernetes):** Architected and managed a fault-tolerant cloud ecosystem on **AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda)**. Leveraged **AWS EKS (Elastic Kubernetes Service)** to containerize and orchestrate microservices, enabling auto-scaling capabilities that handled peak traffic surges with 99.99% availability.
- **Performance Engineering & Caching:** Drastically reduced API latency and server load by implementing a multi-tier caching strategy using **Redis**. This optimization improved frontend responsiveness by over **40%**, directly enhancing user retention and system efficiency.
- **Advanced API Design (GraphQL & Python):** Designed flexible, high-performance APIs using **GraphQL** across Java and Python services. By implementing a unified data graph, empowered frontend teams to reduce network overhead and iterate faster on UI/UX requirements.
- **High-Volume Data Processing:** Developed robust, automated data pipelines using **Spring Batch**. Engineered complex cron-driven workflows to ingest and analyze multi-source third-party API data, ensuring data integrity for critical business reporting.
- **Frontend Excellence:** Crafted intuitive, responsive Single Page Applications (SPAs) using **Angular, TypeScript, and Material UI**. Focused on component reusability and state management to deliver a seamless, high-performance user interface across all device types.
- **Technical Mentorship & Quality Governance:** Directed rigorous code review cycles and established "Best Practice" documentation. Mentored junior engineers in clean code principles and SOLID design patterns, raising the overall engineering bar for the organization.